



Unity to be dropped

Ubuntu's Unity to be dropped due to financial issues. Canonical decides to concentrate on GNOME instead. <http://dgit.in/Unityout>



An Uber-proof future

A prototype for an encrypted Uber that will track your everyday movements called ORide has been developed. <http://dgit.in/OnotU>

Intel Core i9 7900X 2017 CPU Wars - Round 2

The Intel Core i9 7900X represents Intel's comeback attempt after AMD's much lauded Ryzen launch. While the entire stack of the new X299 platform is yet to be available in retail channels, the initial lot brings us the Core i9 7900X. Yes, we now have an entirely new lineup for the Extreme Edition CPUs and there are going to be more than one, at least for now. A good thing about competition is that the pricing becomes way better. Earlier, Extreme Edition SKUs would cost around USD 999 with the only exception of Broadwell-E which cost USD 1723 which was a ridiculous price for a 10-core processor. Now the 10-core Skylake-X successor costs



Price
₹85,000

the same old USD 999. You can be pretty certain had AMD not mentioned ThreadRipper, the 7900X would have been priced at around USD 1723.



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As for the changes to the microarchitecture, we see the move from Ring Bus to Mesh along with the addition of AVX512 support. This should help with performance

in quite a few mainstream as well as enterprise grade applications. As for the performance, this move has resulted in a few setbacks with gaming performance. The Kabylake 7700K is still better and in turn, the 7900X is better than AMD's Ryzen 7 1800X as well but this is understandable given that game engines aren't optimised for such a high core count. However, on the rendering front the 7900X takes a massive leap over all its predecessors as well as AMD's Ryzen 7 1800X. The wait now begins for ThreadRipper which is set to supposedly outperform the 7900X. However, Intel also has an answer to that in the 18-core 7980XE set to launch in August.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CLOCK SPEED: 3.3 GHz | TURBO FREQUENCY: 4.3 GHz | CORES/THREADS: 10/20 | LITHOGRAPHY: 14nm | TDP: 140W | PCIe LANES: 44 | PCIe VERSION: 3.0 | MEMORY SUPPORT: DDR4.

CONTACT

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ASUS PRIME X299-DELUXE

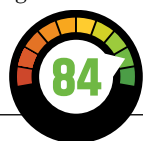
A mixture of features and class

It's been a confusing time for motherboard manufacturers with the new X299 platform since there are CPUs with different counts of PCIe lanes with the flagship ones having 44-lanes, the not so flagship ones having 28-lanes and the last tier having 16-lanes. The number of features on your motherboard just start shutting down as you move down the CPU hierarchy and building a BIOS to accommodate that is easy. But making the entire process seem simple enough for your customers isn't. The ASUS PRIME X299-DELUXE has quite a few neat features like including WiGig along with a superior audio solution. The placement of an x4 PCIe slot at the 3rd row is a



Price
₹39,000

bit weird since most graphics cards are dual-slot with the exception of few flagships that are triple-slot. We like the fact that ASUS has not gone full RGB with this board but has opted to retain a certain amount of class with the aesthetics of the motherboard. There's VROC support should you



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decide to go all crazy but the fact that you need to spend more and get a physical key is one of the worst things to happen to the X299 platform. Another neat feature is the little OLED screen built onto the motherboard which conveys diagnostic messages, CPU freq., fan speeds and the usual stuff. Overall, the PRIME X299-DELUXE is a very feature rich motherboard for the new X299 platform although it's a little on the pricer end of the spectrum.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

CHIPSET: Intel X299 | MEMORY SUPPORT: 8x4133(OC)MHz upto 128GB | LAN: 1x Intel i219V, 1x Intel i211-AT | AUDIO: ALC S1220A 7.1 | STORAGE: 7x SATA III, 1x U.2, 2x M.2 | EXPANSION: 4x PCIe x16(x16+x16+x16+x4) | DIMENSIONS (LxWxD): 305 mm x 244 mm

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